

TCS & AMD AI Hackathon – Participant Handbook

Welcome to the TCS & AMD AI Hackathon! This handbook provides all the essential information to help you successfully participate, build, and submit your AI solutions.

OVERVIEW

This hackathon gives developers the opportunity to explore and build AI workloads using AMD's cloud-based AI stack with access to powerful AMD GPUs—no hardware setup required.

All development happens using **cloud-accessible AMD GPUs**. The focus is on experimenting, benchmarking, and running real workloads in a flexible environment.

STEPS TO FOLLOW

This hackathon gives developers the opportunity to explore and build AI workloads using AMD's cloud-based AI stack.

1. Register to AMD Partner Portal: <https://arena.amd.com/prelogin.html>

Register on **arena.amd.com** using your TCS email id to access personalized AMD training, track your progress and build expertise in AMD technologies.

2. AMD AI Developer Program

The build part of the hackathon will be done on AMD GPU Cloud Instances

Sign-up on <https://developer.amd.com/> (using TCS email id only) to Go through the Developer Learning material from AI Academy. Connect with the Community.

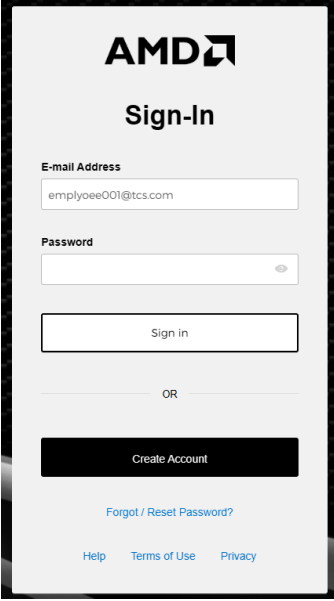
The AMD AI Developer Program offers on-demand access to AMD Instinct GPUs through the cloud. It allows developers to spin up powerful GPU environments in minutes and focus on building and testing AI workloads without infrastructure overhead.

What developers typically use it for:

- Training and fine-tuning machine learning models
- Benchmarking AI workloads on AMD GPUs
- Prototyping AI systems before moving to on-prem infrastructure
- \$100 in AMD Developer Cloud credits for AMD AI Developer Program members that you **can avail after this hackathon is completed on 14th June, 2026.**

How to access your AMD GPU cloud instance for the Hackathon?

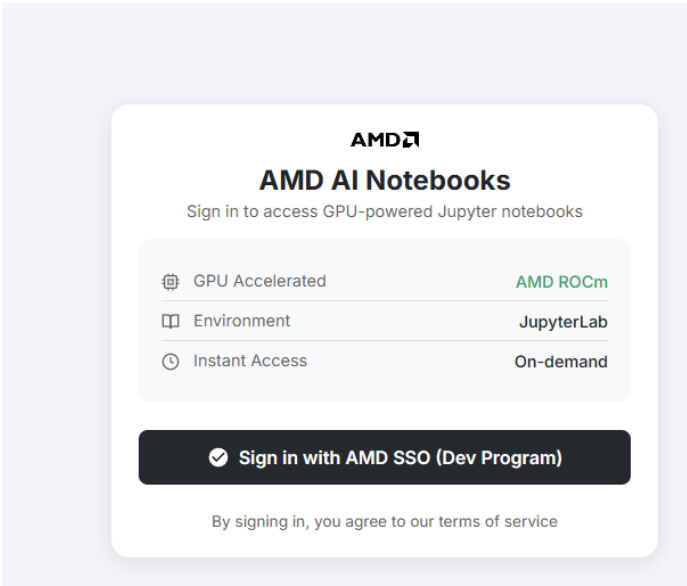
- 1) Ensure you have signed-up for [AMD AI Developer Program](#) with the same email id you registered for the Hackathon to participate (**use your TCS email id only**)



The image shows a mobile-style sign-in form for AMD. At the top is the AMD logo. Below it is the heading "Sign-In". There are two input fields: "E-mail Address" with the placeholder text "employee001@tcs.com" and "Password" with a toggle icon. Below the password field is a "Sign in" button. Underneath is an "OR" separator. Below that is a "Create Account" button. At the bottom, there is a link "Forgot / Reset Password?" and three links: "Help", "Terms of Use", and "Privacy".

2) Accessing the GPU Cloud Instance:

To access the Cloud Instance, Sign-in here: <https://notebooks.amd.com/tcs-hackathon>



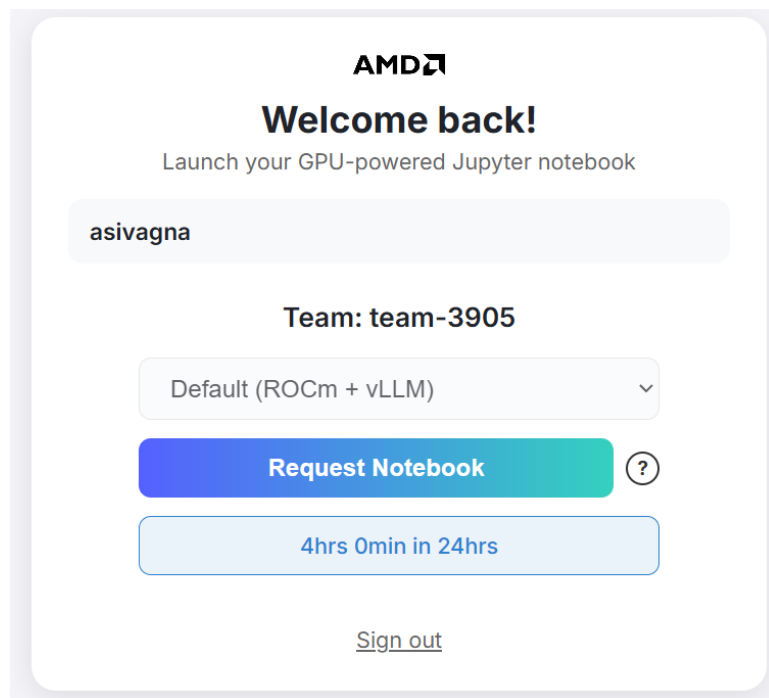
The image shows a web page for "AMD AI Notebooks". At the top is the AMD logo. Below it is the heading "AMD AI Notebooks" and the subtext "Sign in to access GPU-powered Jupyter notebooks". There is a table with three rows and two columns:

GPU Accelerated	AMD ROCm
Environment	JupyterLab
Instant Access	On-demand

Below the table is a large black button with a white checkmark icon and the text "Sign in with AMD SSO (Dev Program)". At the bottom, there is a small text line: "By signing in, you agree to our terms of service".

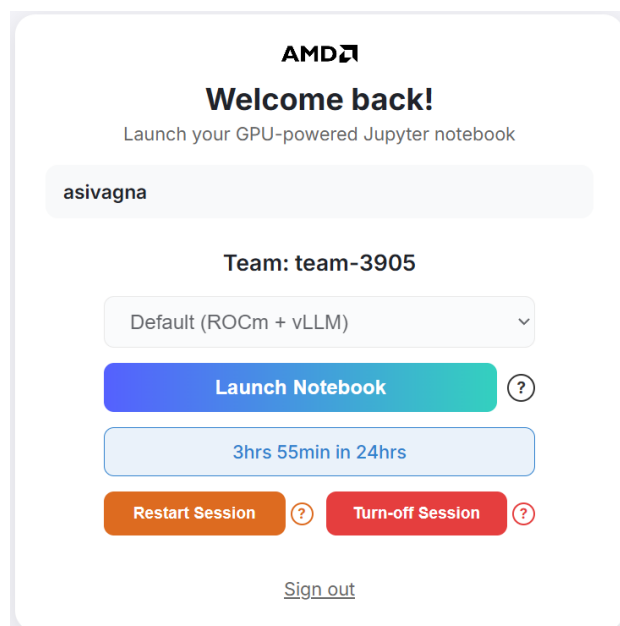
3) Launch your Jupyter Notebook Page

Based on the Login information you will be automatically Assigned to a team / Individual Hacker ID. And you will be logged into your AMD GPU powered Notebook.



Note: GPUs are in limited supply. To ensure fair access to resources, we will slice them for 4 hours in a 24-hour period, on a first-come-first-serve basis per team. In case of unavailable GPUs try again after a while.

- To ensure fair GPU availability, we will assign each Team/Individual Entrant 4 hours of GPU time every 24-hours.
Pro Tip: Plan your GPU usage efficiently and intelligently to maximize your usage during your assigned hours.
- You will see how much time is left every time you enter the Notebook. See sample below.



- **“Turn off sessions”** in case you want to come back later to use the GPU time remaining within the 24-hours period.
- Your GPU Notebook session will get killed after the 4-hours. You will have to wait for 24-hours before you access the GPU instance again.

- Once you run out of time you will see a message "Your team has used up 4 hours of GPU time for 24hrs".
- Remember to save your work in your "/workspace/shared" folder.
- Ensure you **download your Code base on your local laptop/desktop** for Final Submission.
- Please note the VFS storage will get Destroyed once the Hackathon will be completed on 14th June, 2026.
- You can resume your work from where you left off and retrieve your code base from the VFS storage.

Collaborative Development for a 2–3 Member Team

- **Team Structure & Ownership:** For a 2 ~ 3 members team, divide the solution into modules and assign clear ownership for parallel development.
- **Integration Approach:** Members of the team can interact with the Jupyter Notebook using Jupyter real time Collaboration. Connect modules using appropriate IP configurations and API interfaces to enable seamless communication.
- **Validation & Alignment:** Perform end-to-end integration testing with continuous collaboration to ensure performance, compatibility and timely submission.

Community/Expert Connect

Stay connected with AMD experts for the duration of the Hackathon to get answers for your technical queries. Install Discord application on your **personal device**.

- Sign-up for AMD Discord, Register using your personal email id & verify it.
- Click on + to Join a Server
- **Ensure you join the AMD-TCS AI Hackathon Discord Channel for Support from AMD Experts available through 8th June to 14th June: [Join the AMD TCS AI Hackathon Discord Server!](#)**

Hackathon Submission

The final submission will happen on "Ultimatix Prime Events".

Following must be submitted –

1. **3–5 slide presentation (PDF or PPT)**

Slide 1 – Basic Information

- Team name
- Names of the team members / individual / role in the team for the Hackathon (Research, coding, building the business case, presentation, etc)
- Project Title
- Short Description

Slide 2 – Problem & Context

- Problem statement
- Target users / stakeholders
- Why this problem matters (business or operational relevance)
- Mapped hackathon challenge

Slide 3 – Solution Overview

- Solution architecture / workflow diagram
- AI approach used (e.g., GenAI, RAG, agents, vision, speech, multimodal)
- Key technologies / frameworks leveraged
- What was built during the hackathon

Slide 4

- Models used
- Dataset(s) used (if fine-tuning)
- Training time (if fine tuning)

- Number of tokens used for a couple of example scenarios
- End-to-end latency
- GPU usage including memory (gives a sense of right sizing)

Slide 5 – Impact & Demo Summary

- Expected impact or value (efficiency, productivity, scale, experience)
- Key differentiators / innovation
- Demo flow overview (what the jury should notice)

NOTE : The template is uploaded on the Prime Hub page

2. Demo Recording

Use one of the following recording tools which must be available on your device –

1. Microsoft Clipchamp
2. Google Vids

If there is no recording app present in your laptop/desktop, take the screenshots, save them as a pdf and submit

Understand ROCm (Radeon Open Compute) for the use-case development

ROCm is AMD's open-source software platform for GPU computing, the AMD equivalent of NVIDIA's CUDA. It lets you run AI/ML workloads and HPC applications on AMD GPUs.

What developers commonly use it for:

- Running PyTorch and TensorFlow on AMD GPUs
- Porting CUDA-based workloads to AMD hardware
- Executing high-performance AI and ML workloads

Documentation

- [ROCm documentation](#)
- [ROCm installation guide](#)

What developers often use it for:

- Learning how to build and run AI workloads on AMD hardware
- Exploring fine-tuning and reinforcement learning workflows

Access

- Free access to all courses
- Includes hands-on labs with real GPU access
- Developed in partnership with [DeepLearning.AI](#) for advanced content

Evaluation Criteria

Criteria	Description	Weightage
Problem Definition & Relevance	Clarity of problem, relevance to real-world / enterprise scenarios	10%
Technical Implementation	Correct and effective application of AI/ML techniques, working solution	40%
Learnings and Future work	Impact, usefulness, scalability, applicability	20%
Innovation & Creativity	Novelty, differentiation, unique approach	15%
Presentation & Demo Quality	Clarity of explanation, demo flow, storytelling	15%

FAQs:

1. **GPU resources may be subject to peak usage constraints during the hackathon.**
In such cases, temporary unavailability may occur, and participants are advised to retry after some time
2. **What / where are the expected test data sets?**
Participants are Expected to Bring their own Datasets. Use only Public Datasets. Nothing Proprietary to TCS.
3. **When will the credits be allocated, so that I can create the GPU Droplet?**
We are not using the Credit based System for Hackathon. See the TimeSlice GPU details above in the **How to access your AMD GPU cloud instance for the Hackathon?** section.

Once the Hackathon is Completed each individual will receive 100\$ Credit as promised in the past.

4. **Is there Git etc. in the VM to store the code?**
No. the Code will be stored on the GPU Cloud Server. You will have to download the Code base to your local PC/Laptop for Submission. Each team will have 28GB of space.
5. **Queries on Discord**
Please try to login and Connect to the Discord Channel: [Join the AMD TCS AI Hackathon Discord Server!](#)
6. **Is there a Generic Discord Channel Group for AMD Developers**
ADP (AMD Developer's Program) community :
<https://discord.com/invite/CxfXGhdp3J>

NOTE: Further Doubts will be clarified in the Kick-off session planned on 8th June.